



BookmarkBridge

User Guide

Sync Safari and Google Chrome
with visibility, control and backup.

Version 0.9.1 Beta	System requirements macOS 26.5 or later	Engine BSE v1.0
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All processing happens locally on your Mac. This guide is available
without an Internet connection.

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1. Presentation

BookmarkBridge is a native macOS app that syncs Safari and Google Chrome bookmarks back and forth, after a controlled preview.

What the beta does

- Reads Safari libraries and Chrome profiles that you authorize.
- Allows you to select profiles, folders and favorites to synchronize.
- Presents the differences before any modification.
- Creates a restorable backup of Safari or Chrome before each write.

A cautious approach

The dashboard clearly distinguishes between reading, comparison and application. An analysis never modifies your data. Synchronization always requires explicit action after preview.

To remember

Both directions use the same secure pipeline: preview, confirmation, backup, transaction, commit, and fallback.

2. Installation

BookmarkBridge 0.9.1 Beta requires macOS 26.5 or later and runs on 64-bit Apple Silicon and Intel Macs.

Install the app

- 1 Download and open BookmarkBridge-0.9.1-build-1.dmg.
- 2 Drag BookmarkBridge.app to the Applications shortcut.
- 3 Open BookmarkBridge from the Applications folder.
- 4 Follow the welcome guide when first launching.
- 5 Grant Safari and Chrome access separately when macOS requests them.

Supported Browsers

This version supports Safari and Google Chrome. Firefox, Edge and other browsers are not yet available.

No login required

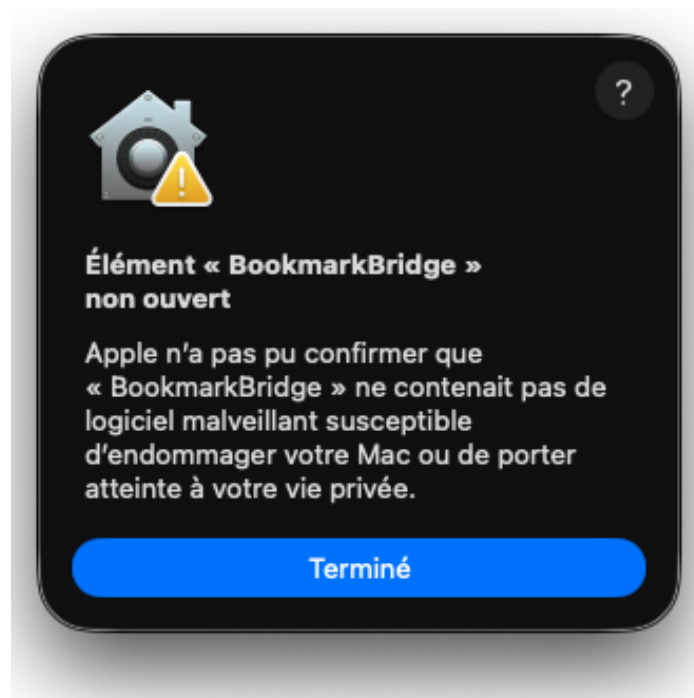
BookmarkBridge does not depend on any online account and does not send your bookmarks to a remote service.

First opening - step 1 of 3

The beta is not yet notarized by Apple. The first macOS crash is therefore expected and does not require disabling Gatekeeper.

Try opening

After placing BookmarkBridge in Applications, open the app from there. When macOS displays “BookmarkBridge item not open,” click Done.



Expected message

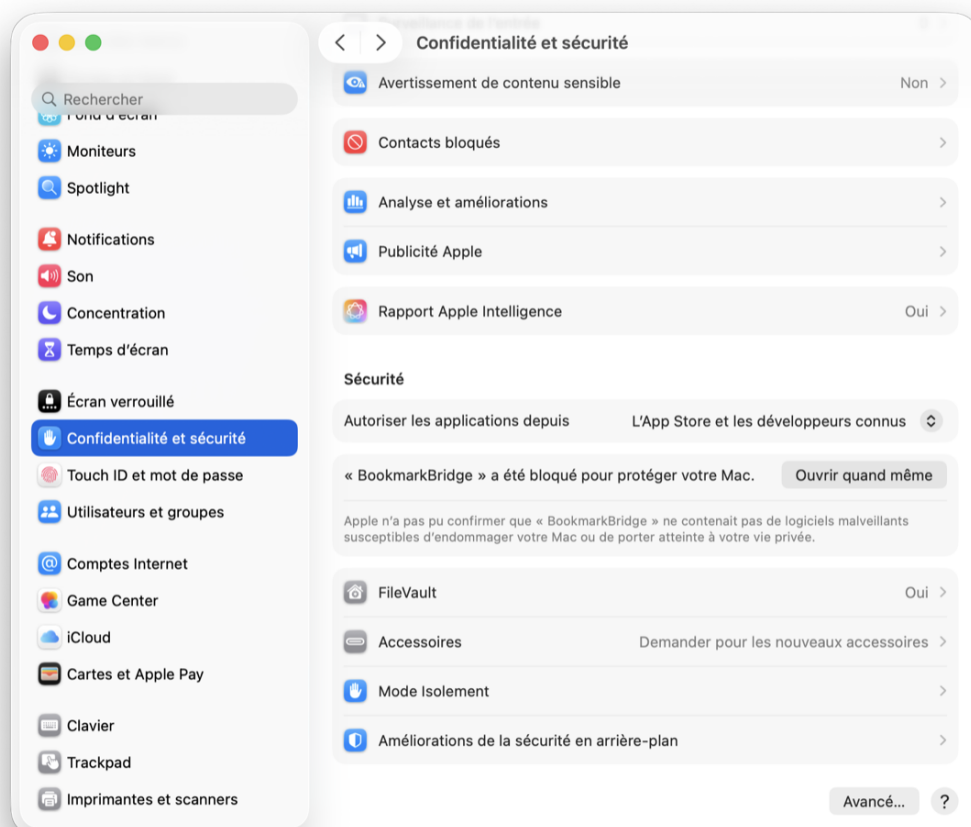
This message appears because this beta has not yet been signed or notarized by Apple. Proceed only if the displayed name is BookmarkBridge.

First opening - step 2 of 3

Open System Settings, then Privacy & Security. Scroll down to the Security section.

Authorize this app

Next to the message “BookmarkBridge has been blocked to protect your Mac,” click Open anyway. The button appears only after the first opening attempt.

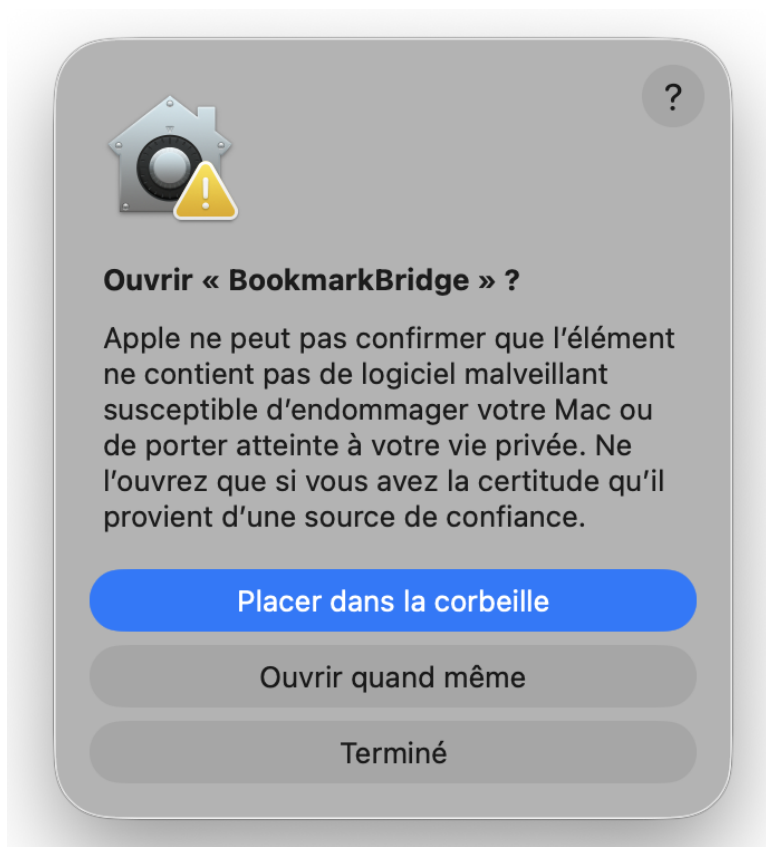


First opening - step 3 of 3

macOS asks for a final confirmation before launching BookmarkBridge.

Confirm opening

Click Open Anyway. macOS may ask for your password or Touch ID. BookmarkBridge will then open normally.



Protections retained

This procedure only allows BookmarkBridge. It does not disable Gatekeeper or other application security controls.

3. Setup

The setup links BookmarkBridge to chosen libraries using macOS's secure file picker.

Safari

- 1 In the dashboard, choose Allow for Safari.
- 2 Select the Bookmarks.plist file offered in the Safari folder.
- 3 Verify that the Allowed status appears before continuing.

Google Chrome

- 1 Choose Allow for Chrome.
- 2 Select the requested Chrome folder, then the profile to use.
- 3 Check the number of favorites detected in the dashboard.

Multiple Chrome profiles

Each profile maintains its own library. Synchronization uses the selected local profile as source or target. A profile that simultaneously contains active local storage and account storage remains read-only.

4. Synchronization

Synchronization follows the same secure path in both directions: select, view, then confirm.

Recommended procedure

- 1 Reload the sources to read their current status.
- 2 Choose the direction Safari to Chrome or Chrome to Safari.
- 3 Check the profiles, folders and favorites to synchronize.
- 4 Review the full overview of the operations offered.
- 5 Close Safari and Chrome.
- 6 Confirm synchronization is applied.
- 7 Check the result and then reopen the browsers.

Explicit selection

An unchecked item is ignored entirely by the comparison and transaction. It is never deleted just because it is unchecked.

Supported Operations

Depending on the direction and selection, the preview may suggest address creations, deletions, moves, renames and updates in the target browser. Nothing is applied until your confirmation.

After application

BookmarkBridge automatically reloads the dashboard and preview. A second execution, without further modification, should show zero operations.

5. Permissions and Privacy

The macOS sandbox prevents an app from freely accessing your files. So you explicitly choose each library.

Why macOS asks for permission

The permission is saved by macOS in a secure form. BookmarkBridge does not browse your other documents or ask you to disable system protections.

If an authorization expires

Choose Allow again from the dashboard, then select the same library. This operation does not modify any favorites.

Local data

- No favorites are transmitted over the network.
- Chrome AccountBookmarks remains read-only.
- A Safari or Chrome backup precedes any changes to the target browser.
- Safari and Chrome must be closed while writing or restoring.

Explicit control

An analysis always has no effect on the data. Only the preview confirmation button authorizes writing.

6. Frequently asked questions

The answers below cover the most common situations.

Why does Chrome appear blank?

Check the selected profile and its authorization. A different profile may contain a separate library.

What happens if I uncheck a favorite?

It is excluded from comparison, preview and transaction. Unchecking it never causes it to be deleted.

Why does a folder appear duplicated?

Folders with the same name can belong to different paths. Consult their hierarchy in the explorer.

Can I sync multiple Chrome profiles?

Yes. Each sync uses a specific local Chrome profile as the source or target. Choose its name, then refine the selection folder by folder and favorite by favorite.

What happens if I delete a favorite?

The preview may suggest removing it in the target browser to reflect the selected source. It is only applied after confirmation and saving of the target.

How to restore a backup?

Close Safari and Chrome, open the latest sync result, choose Restore and confirm. The dashboard is then reloaded.

7. Troubleshooting

Messages from BookmarkBridge indicate the probable cause and the action to take.

Unable to access Safari

The permission has probably expired or the file has been moved. Choose Allow, then select Bookmarks.plist again.

Safari and Chrome must be closed

Quit Safari and Chrome with Command-Q. Verify that no windows or processes in these browsers remain active, and then try again.

Two Chrome storages are detected

The profile contains local data and account data. BookmarkBridge keeps it read-only so as not to arbitrarily choose a source.

Preview is not displayed

Reload Safari and Chrome from the dashboard. Correct the reported permissions, then rerun the comparison.

Your data remains protected

If this fails, BookmarkBridge aborts the operation and keeps the existing bookmarks. Do not manually modify browser files.

8. Best practices

A few simple habits make every sync easier to check.

- Always review the preview before confirming.
- Close Safari and Chrome before syncing or restoring.
- Do not move browser files during an operation.
- Start with a Chrome profile whose content you know.
- After a sync, check a few bookmarks in Safari or the target Chrome profile.
- Keep the app updated and see What's New after an upgrade.

Before an important operation

Recharge both sources, check their meters and take the time to read any warning boxes. If a profile is marked read-only, do not attempt to circumvent this protection.

**Essential
principle**

The safety of favorites takes precedence over speed. If in doubt, cancel the operation and consult the view's context-sensitive help.

9. Appendix

Technical references and vocabulary useful for understanding the application.

Glossary

- Preview: readable simulation of changes, without writing.
- Library: set of favorites and folders in a browser.
- Chrome profile: Chrome user area with its own favorites.
- Backup: restorable copy of the target library created before a write.
- Sens: Safari to Chrome or Chrome to Safari choice which determines the source and target.
- Selection: explicit scope of elements included in the synchronization.

Beta Compatibility

- BookmarkBridge 0.9.1 Beta, build 1.
- BSE v1.0.
- macOS 26.5 or later.
- Safari and Google Chrome.
- Universal binary arm64 and x86_64.

Confirmed limits

Only Safari and Google Chrome are supported. Chrome AccountBookmarks remains read-only. There is no cloud, multi-machine, real-time, or background synchronization.

Built-in help

For information adapted to the screen displayed, use the help button “?” “. The Help Center is also available in the Help menu.